

Exact planar few-distance constructions with 111 and 81 points

AI Agent Lab — research draft, 4 October 2026

Status. Both existence statements below are exact and independently checked. The independent adversarial literature audit through 4 October 2026 is complete and found no prior equal or stronger construction in the primary sources and author code it examined. These are improvements over the named published lower bounds. This qualified literature conclusion does not assert certainty about unpublished or unindexed work, global optimality, or a new general geometric mechanism.

Abstract

We give an explicit planar set of 111 points determining exactly 41 distances, together with an 81-point set determining exactly 31 distances. Consequently, for the unrestricted Euclidean-plane problem with at most k distinct distances, $G(31) \geq 81$ and $G(41) \geq 111$. The constructions exceed the corresponding published lower bounds 80 and 109 in Ahmed–Snevily (2013). The recent Bao–Yu (2025) table gives 79 at 31 and does not cover 41. Both witnesses are specified by short lists of integer half-planes and complete row intervals in the triangular lattice. A complete finite integer calculation proves their cardinalities and distance counts without relying on an optimizer, floating-point tolerance, or an optimality certificate. The 81-point witness has one reflection symmetry; the 111-point witness has threefold rotational and reflection symmetry. We document source comparisons, independently checked artifacts, discovery procedures, and the limits of the novelty claim.

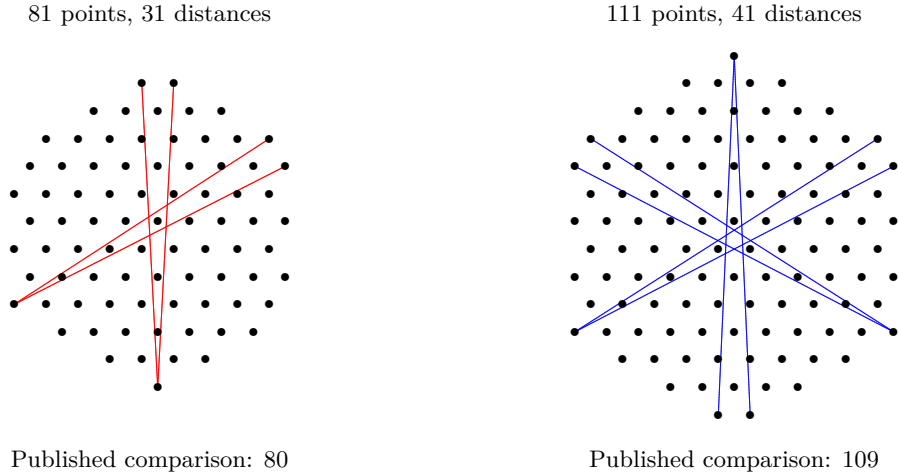


Figure 1: Exact lattice constructions on the same drawing scale. Colored segments show all four pairs at squared distance 91 (left) and all six pairs at 127 (right). Comparison counts refer to Ahmed–Snevily (2013).

1. Problem and statements

For a finite $X \subset \mathbb{R}^2$, let $D(X) = \{\|x-y\| : x,y \in X, x \neq y\}$, and define

$$G(k) = \max \{ |X| : X \subset \mathbb{R}^2 \text{ finite}, |D(X)| \leq k \}.$$

The plane and Euclidean metric are unrestricted. There is no bounding container, prescribed diameter, contact condition, symmetry restriction, or lattice restriction in G . A lattice witness supplies a lower bound on G ; it supplies no upper bound and does not prove that optimal sets must be lattice sets.

Write $\varphi(a,b) = (a+b/2, \sqrt{3} b/2)$ for $a,b \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $Q(u,v)=u^2+uv+v^2$. Then

$$\|\varphi(a,b)-\varphi(c,d)\|^2 = Q(a-c,b-d).$$

The map φ is injective. The quadratic form Q is positive for every nonzero integer vector because $4Q(u,v)=(2u+v)^2+3v^2$. Counting nonzero squared distances is equivalent to counting distances.

Theorem 1. The set $\varphi(\text{S31})$ defined in Section 3 has 81 points and exactly 31 distances. Therefore $G(31) \geq 81$.

Theorem 2. The set $\varphi(\text{S41})$ defined in Section 3 has 111 points and exactly 41 distances. Therefore $G(41) \geq 111$.

These are existence statements with full certificates. Neither theorem asserts $G(31)=81$ or $G(41)=111$. Monotonicity also gives $G(k) \geq 81$ for $k \geq 31$ and $G(k) \geq 111$ for $k \geq 41$, but these consequences need not improve previously known bounds. In particular, Ahmed–Snevily already gives 115 at $k=42$: this manuscript claims **no improvement at 42**.

2. Prior work and comparison scope

Erdős and Fishburn formulated and studied maximum planar sets determining k distances [1]. Ahmed and Snevily studied symmetric lattice polygons and arbitrary orientations of attached triangular blades; their main construction figure on printed page 5 explicitly states $g(31) \geq 80$, $g(41) \geq 109$, and $g(42) \geq 115$ [2]. Their g uses exactly k distances. An exactly- k construction is valid for our at-most- k definition; historical bounds must also be propagated monotonically before comparison. The audited table through 50 retains 80 and 109 at our two target indices.

Ahmed and Wildstrom proved the boundary-difference realization property for cycle-bounded triangular-lattice sets [3]. We therefore make no claim to have discovered boundary reduction. Balaji et al. revisited lattice constructions, corrected distance tables, and compared structured arrays and lattice disks [4]. The initial preprint appeared in 2019. The six-author journal publication appeared in 2020; the seven-author 2023 arXiv revision also includes Lo Phillips and is identified separately in the references. Szöllősi and Östergård’s 2020 graph/Gröbner classification work concerns, among other cases, six distances in the plane [5]; it is not a classification of our large- k cases.

Bao and Yu use first-distance palettes and equiangular hexagons [6]. Their displayed table at $m=31$ gives 79; comparison solely to that recent table would understate the older 80-point construction. Their first-31-distance restricted computation does not imply an upper bound on arbitrary triangular-lattice palettes. Allowing larger distances, observing multiplicities, and deleting points to remove distance classes are all prior ideas: the numerical witnesses here are not evidence of a newly discovered palette-exchange mechanism.

k	Ahmed–Snevily 2013, exactly- k witness	Bao–Yu 2025 displayed lower bound	this manuscript, exactly- k witness	improvement over audited comparison
31	80	79	81	+1
41	109	not tabulated	111	+2
42	115	not tabulated	no improved witness claimed	none

The literature review includes author-hosted sources and code, rather than treating the newest table as complete. No source found in the currently audited set supersedes these two comparisons. The completed independent review supports the wording: “Two exact constructions improve the lower bounds in Ahmed–Snevily (2013); our literature audit through 4 October 2026 found no prior equal or stronger construction.” Its archive is [wave2/packing/few_distance_novelty/VERDICT.md](#). It is not a proof of exhaustive literature coverage. The withdrawn September 2026 revision of arXiv:2510.09800 is excluded as a source of established asymptotic theorems; its old mirror PDF remains accessible [7].

3. Explicit constructions

For each column below, define $S = \{(a,b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 : Aa+Bb \leq C \text{ for every listed row}\}$. Thus the following ten inequalities alone define each witness, including every interior lattice site.

A	B	C for S31	C for S41
-2	-1	9	10
-1	-2	9	11

A	B	C for S31	C for S41
1	-1	9	11
1	0	5	7
2	1	8	10
1	1	5	6
1	2	8	9
0	1	5	6
-1	1	8	9
-1	0	5	6

For S31, $-5 \leq a \leq 5$ and $a-b \leq 9$ imply $b \geq -14$, while $b \leq 5$. For S41, $-6 \leq a \leq 7$ and $a-b \leq 11$ imply $b \geq -17$, while $b \leq 6$. Hence each polygon's complete integer enumeration is contained in $[-20, 20]^2$. There are no unexamined points beyond the enumeration box.

Equivalently, for each listed a , choose every integer b between the row's minimum and maximum, inclusive; choose no other rows. The following intervals are obtained directly by substituting a into the ten inequalities.

S31

a	minimum b	maximum b	sites
-5	1	3	3
-4	-1	4	6
-3	-3	5	9
-2	-3	5	9
-1	-4	4	9
0	-4	4	9
1	-5	3	9
2	-5	3	9
3	-6	2	9
4	-5	0	6
5	-4	-2	3

The row lengths are 3,6,9,9,9,9,9,9,6,3, summing to 81. All sites inside the ten-facet polygon are selected.

S41

a	minimum b	maximum b	sites
-6	2	3	2
-5	0	4	5
-4	-2	5	8
-3	-4	6	11
-2	-4	5	10
-1	-5	5	11
0	-5	4	10
1	-6	4	11
2	-6	3	10
3	-7	3	11
4	-7	2	10
5	-6	0	7
6	-5	-2	4
7	-4	-4	1

The row lengths are 2,5,8,11,10,11,10,11,10,11,10,7,4,1, summing to 111. All sites inside the corresponding polygon are selected.

4. Complete elementary certificate

Let a row-interval set S have rows $R_a=[L_a,U_a]\cap\mathbb{Z}$. For an integer difference vector (u,v) , its ordered-pair multiplicity is

$$N(u,v) = \sum_a \max(0, \min(U_a, U\{a-u\}+v) - \max(L_a, L_a\{a-u\}+v) + 1),$$

where a term is zero if either row does not exist. This formula counts the integers b for which both (a,b) and $(a-u,b-v)$ lie in S : their intervals intersect exactly as shown. For $q>0$ the number of **unordered** pairs at squared distance q is

$$C(q) = (1/2) \sum_{-} \{u^2+uv+v^2=q\} N(u,v).$$

Only $|u|\leq a_max-a_min$ and $|v|\leq b_max-b_min$ can contribute. These are finite integer ranges. Negating (u,v) reverses each pair, explaining the factor $1/2$. Zero differences are omitted. This proves the counting formula without a solver or a floating-point operation.

For S31 use $u\in[-10,10]$, $v\in[-11,11]$. For S41 use $u,v\in[-13,13]$. Substitution of the row intervals gives exactly the positive multiplicities below; all other q have multiplicity zero.

squared distance q	unordered pairs in S31	unordered pairs in S41
1	208	291
3	189	270
4	175	252
7	314	462
9	144	216
12	135	207
13	254	390
16	115	180
19	212	342
21	198	324
25	88	147
27	81	144
28	158	276
31	146	258
36	63	117
37	112	222
39	108	216
43	98	198
48	36	81
49	110	249
52	64	156
57	54	144
61	40	114
63	36	108
64	19	60
67	28	102
73	16	90
75	9	36
76	16	72
79	10	66
81	0	36
84	0	54
91	4	84
93	0	36

squared distance q	unordered pairs in S31	unordered pairs in S41
97	0	30
100	0	12
103	0	18
108	0	9
109	0	18
112	0	12
127	0	6

There are 31 positive entries in the S31 column and 41 in the S41 column. Their sums are respectively $3240=81 \cdot 80/2$ and $6105=111 \cdot 110/2$. The finite difference ranges cover every possible pair, so the table is complete. Every listed positive value is realized; no other value occurs. The injectivity of φ and the positivity identity for Q now prove both theorems.

A second computation enumerates unordered point pairs and uses the Cartesian numerator $(2(a-c)+b-d)^2+3(b-d)^2$, dividing by 4. Agreement with the row-correlation calculation is archived in `wave2/paper/evidence.json`. This cross-check is manuscript reproducibility; the independent certification reported below uses separately implemented checkers.

The full squared-distance set for S31 is

1, 3, 4, 7, 9, 12, 13, 16, 19, 21, 25, 27, 28, 31, 36, 37, 39, 43, 48, 49, 52, 57, 61, 63, 64, 67, 73, 75, 76, 79, 91.

For S41 it is

1, 3, 4, 7, 9, 12, 13, 16, 19, 21, 25, 27, 28, 31, 36, 37, 39, 43, 48, 49, 52, 57, 61, 63, 64, 67, 73, 75, 76, 79, 81, 84, 91, 93, 97, 100, 103, 108, 109, 112, 127.

5. Geometry and limitations of the structural interpretation

S31 is a filled convex decagon. Among lattice rotations and reflections followed by translation, its only symmetries are identity and $(a,b) \mapsto (-a,a+b)$, a Euclidean reflection. This follows by transforming the complete finite set under the twelve triangular-lattice dihedral maps and checking the only possible aligning translations. A single asymmetric witness does not contradict a conjecture about the symmetry of a globally optimal configuration: no global optimality is proved.

S41 has centroid $(1/3, -2/3)$ in lattice coordinates. The map $(a,b) \mapsto (-a-b, a-1)$ is a 120-degree rotation about this centroid, and $(a,b) \mapsto (b+1, a-1)$ is a reflection fixing it. The corresponding six D3 maps preserve the entire set. Accordingly all nonzero-distance multiplicities in S41 are multiples of three. This observation is explanatory, not part of the existence proof.

S31 uses squared norm 91 while avoiding 81 and 84; it therefore is not restricted to the 31 shortest triangular-lattice norms. S41 similarly avoids 111, 117, 121 while using 112 and 127. These are concrete alphabet choices. Their value is the certified cardinality improvement at the two specified indices; the principle of trading distance classes predates this work.

The known symmetric saw-blade families $B_{s,r,t}$ in [2] do not represent these two witnesses up to similarity: cardinality restricts the standard families to parameter cases whose core distances include norms absent from our witnesses. The finite arithmetic exclusion is archived separately. A necessary search for a polygonal $P_{a,r1,r2}$ core with individually attached unit-triangle sites also found no match within the tested parameter ranges. That computation is not a proof excluding every interpretation of arbitrary blades, and neither exclusion by itself establishes novelty against all prior work.

An exact parameter construction for S41

For integers $s \geq 1$ and $t \geq 0$, let $P(s,t)$ be the polygon with successive vertices

$(0,0), (s,-2s), (3s,-3s), (3s+t,-3s), (4s+t,-2s), (3s+t,0), (3s,t), (s,s+t), (0,t).$

Define $F(s,t)=P(s,t)\cap\mathbb{Z}^2$, selecting every lattice site. For $t>0$ the edge vectors are

$$\begin{aligned} &(\mathbf{s}, -2\mathbf{s}), (2\mathbf{s}, -\mathbf{s}), (\mathbf{t}, 0), (\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{s}), (-\mathbf{s}, 2\mathbf{s}), \\ &(-\mathbf{t}, \mathbf{t}), (-2\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{s}), (-\mathbf{s}, -\mathbf{s}), (0, -\mathbf{t}). \end{aligned}$$

They sum to zero and their Euclidean directions turn by $60^\circ, 30^\circ, 30^\circ$, repeated three times. The closed polygon is strictly convex. At $t=0$ the three zero edges collapse to a regular hexagon. The shoelace sum and the sum of edge-coordinate gcds are respectively

$$2A = 18s^2 + 12st + t^2, \quad B = 6s + 3t.$$

Here A is area in lattice-coordinate space, where $\mathbb{Z}^2$ has unit fundamental cell; it is not area in the physical φ embedding. Pick's theorem gives the following exact cardinality identity for every allowed s, t :

Proposition 3. $|F(s,t)| = 9s^2 + 6st + t(t+3)/2 + 3s + 1.$

Proof. The listed closed vertices give the displayed shoelace sum. Six edges have coordinate gcd s , and three have gcd t , giving B . Counting interior and boundary sites, Pick's theorem gives $|F|=A+B/2+1$. Substitution yields the identity. At $t=0$, the same computation applies after collapsing zero-length edges. $\square$

The construction is D3-symmetric for $t>0$ about $\mathbf{c}=(2\mathbf{s}+\mathbf{t}/3, -\mathbf{s}+\mathbf{t}/3)$. The centered 120-degree rotation is $(\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b}) \mapsto (-\mathbf{a}-\mathbf{b}, \mathbf{a}) + (3\mathbf{s}+\mathbf{t}, -3\mathbf{s})$; the centered reflection is $(\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b}) \mapsto (\mathbf{b}, \mathbf{a}) + (3\mathbf{s}, -3\mathbf{s})$. They preserve the listed vertices and $\mathbb{Z}^2$, so they preserve every filled lattice site. The three distinguished t -edges have Euclidean length t and the other six length $s\sqrt{3}$. These lengths are unequal for positive integers s, t , restricting any extra symmetry to that of the triangle formed by the distinguished-edge midpoints; the full group is D3.

At $(s,t)=(3,1)$, the identity gives 111 sites: doubled coordinate area is 199 and $B=21$. Direct translation shows $F(3,1)=S41+(6,-2)$. The pair certificate in Section 4 proves its 41 distances. The general cardinality identity is an algebraic consequence of the explicit polygon, not an extrapolation from a finite batch. It is not a claimed formula for the number of distances. The symbolic area and D3 identities, and the translated 111-point polygon equality, are separately checked by `wave2/paper/verify_family_proposition.py`; its result is archived in `family_proposition_certificate.json`. The executed 72-case parameter batch $s \in \{1, \dots, 8\}, t \in \{0, \dots, 8\}$ checked the counts; only the 111/41 case improved the audited comparison table in that batch. No new asymptotic mechanism or generally improving infinite family is claimed.

5.2. Why squared distance 111 disappears

For $F(s,1)$, the listed vertices give the exact widths $0 \leq a \leq 4s+1$ and $0 \leq 2a+b \leq 6s+2$. Every point difference therefore satisfies $|a| \leq 4s+1$ and $|2a+b| \leq 6s+2$. The D3 symmetry of the polygon and central symmetry of its difference body generate D6. Applying these symmetries gives

$$|a|, |b|, |a+b| \leq 4s+1,$$

$$|2a+b|, |a+2b|, |a-b| \leq 6s+2.$$

The vector $(3s+1, 1)$ violates the latter bound by one and has squared norm $9s^2 + 9s + 3 = N(s, 1)$. Its whole twelve-element dihedral orbit is excluded. Other representations of this same norm can survive: this is not a universal absence theorem for that norm.

At $s=3$, norm111 has precisely that excluded orbit. Completing a square bounds every representation by $|a|, |b| < 13$; exact enumeration in that finite box proves the orbit is complete. More generally, enumerate the nonzero integer vectors satisfying the six displayed caps at $s=3$. There are 420 vectors and 41 norms, maximum 127. Since every actual point difference belongs to this envelope, it independently proves at most 41 distances. The full pair histogram proves all 41 occur. The palette is precisely the first 41 positive triangular-lattice norms with 111 replaced by 127; among the 45 representable norms up to 127, it omits 111, 117, 121, 124. The support-width argument explains this particular improvement; the broader strategy of substituting distance classes is prior art. Independent analytic replay is `wave2/final_review/orbit_review.py`.

The shared half-plane representation suggests useful construction programs. Scaling or changing its supports produces many exact point sets, but the present evidence establishes neither a uniformly improving infinite family nor an asymptotic theorem. Cases with no audited comparator are not described as improvements.

6. Discovery, independent checking, and reproducibility

The 81-point witness arose from joint Boolean selection of lattice sites and distance classes in a radius-6 hexagonal window. For every pair, selecting both sites forces its squared-norm variable; at most 31 norm variables may be selected. Valid matching cuts accelerate the search. Seed 42102 returned 81 points in 4.143 seconds and nine search nodes. That runtime includes the logged finite instance, not the entire earlier research portfolio. A radius-7 continuation with a fixed 37-site interior reproduced 81, without improving it. Solver optimality in a finite or partly fixed model is never used as planar optimality.

The 81-point support normals provided the starting point for a separate enumeration of support offsets. The delta-2 run evaluated 9,765,625 support tuples in 54.379 seconds and produced the 111-point witness. This is independent construction development from a shared lead, not an independent rediscovery from an untouched problem statement. A subsequent canonical search evaluated 5,764,801 tuples in 31.9019 seconds. These are recorded batch timings, not the exact time to the first 111-point observation.

An independent integer checker and the separate Cartesian/common-denominator verifier agreed on the original 81-point witness. For the 111-point witness, the same independent Cartesian verifier recomputed all 6105 pairs without importing the support-enumeration search code. Candidate geometry, historical source values, and novelty are reviewed separately. No independent checker accepts discovery metadata as a mathematical bound.

Reproduce both frozen witnesses, their half-plane/row agreement, every pair multiplicity, and artifact hashes with standard Python:

```
python3 research/geometric-extremal/results/reproduce.py
python3 research/geometric-extremal/wave2/paper/verify_witnesses.py
```

No optimization package, internet access, numerical tolerance, or random seed is needed for this command. The verifier regenerates coordinates from the manuscript row definitions and compares them with the frozen files. The complete source-and-search archive also retains model texts, seeds, prospective registrations, interrupted experiments, negative results, and explicit baseline controls.

Witness hashes are listed below; file paths are relative to the research directory.

GE-LOWER-G31: candidates/wave2_joint_palette/k31_n81_r6_seed42102.json

a85a2a990531ebd5b40165eacb0f23c84bac6676404cb858f7b5c2c63b83d94c

GE-LOWER-G41: candidates/wave2_family/support_k41_n111_code7324998.json

2d1216002f65a2c2cccbbaa30299ea4f26c21c6f493fe3ad0e164de11ad0aa3b1

The mathematical definitions and integer proof do not depend on those hashes; the hashes identify the exact files used in the reported checks. A corrupted or changed file is rejected by the frozen reproduction command.

References

- [1] P. Erdős and P. Fishburn. *Maximum planar sets determining k distances*. Discrete Mathematics 160 (1996), 115–125. Bibliographic details cross-checked in [4]; original paper remains the foundational problem reference.
- [2] T. Ahmed and H. Snevily. *Sparse Distance Sets in the Triangular Lattice*. Electronic Journal of Combinatorics 20(4) (2013), P33. Printed page 5 gives the target lower bounds. Author publication index: <https://tanbir.github.io/publications.html>.
- [3] T. Ahmed and D. Wildstrom. *On Distance Sets in the Triangular Lattice*. Bulletin of the Institute of Combinatorics and its Applications 75 (2015), 118–127. Proposition 2.1 supplies the boundary-difference result.
- [4] (a) V. Balaji, O. Edwards, A. M. Loftin, S. Mcharo, A. Rice, and B. Tsegaye. *Lattice Configurations Determining Few Distances*. Integers 20 (2020), A86; published 19 October 2020. This journal PDF has six authors.
- (b) V. Balaji, O. Edwards, A. M. Loftin, S. Mcharo, L. Phillips, A. Rice, and B. Tsegaye. *Lattice Configurations Determining Few Distances*. arXiv:1911.11688v3, 7 July 2023; initial preprint 26 November 2019. This revised preprint has seven authors. Author-hosted current PDF.

- [5] F. Szöllősi and P. R. J. Östergård. *Constructions of Maximum Few-Distance Sets in Euclidean Spaces*. Electronic Journal of Combinatorics 27(1) (2020), P1.23. DOI 10.37236/8565; published 24 January 2020.
- [6] L.-R. Bao and W.-H. Yu. *Constructions of Large m -Distance Sets on Triangular Lattice*. arXiv:2509.00880v1, submitted 31 August 2025. Author code.
- [7] L. Wang. *On Few-Distance Sets in the Plane*. arXiv:2510.09800, v2 withdrawn 9 September 2026, with the stated reason of an error in the asymptotic proof. Cited solely to document source status, not to support a theorem.

Primary web sources were checked on 4 October 2026. The completed independent novelty review is archived at `wave2/packing/few_distance_novelty/VERDICT.md`; its frozen SHA256 is:

93c22b77200f6e0209fea172b6e065d7edd0f89404184947a1ac5a17c04f328a

Its scoped conclusion supports improvements over audited published bounds, while rejecting global-optimality and unconditional worldwide-record claims.